If you can, make this soup in advance and let it stand for a while before reheating—it will be even better. It's also good made with shelled overgrown runner beans.

black-eyed pea soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1 tbsp canola oil or sunflower oil
3 leeks, cleaned and sliced
1 small red bell pepper, chopped
1 small yellow bell pepper, chopped
3 garlic cloves
2in (5cm) piece fresh ginger, peeled and grated or coarsely chopped
1 small red chile
1 tsp cumin seeds
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 x 14oz (400g) cans black-eyed peas, drained, rinsed, and drained again
1¾ cups coconut milk
2 cups hot vegetable stock
1 tsp brown sugar
fresh cilantro, to garnish
lime wedges, to serve

1 Heat the oil in a deep saucepan over medium heat, add the leeks and peppers, cover, and cook, stirring frequently, for 5–7 minutes or until soft. Meanwhile, put the garlic, ginger, chile, cumin, and 1 tsp salt in a blender with 4 tbsp water and process until completely smooth. Add to the pan, using a little more water to rinse out every last bit. Cook, stirring, for 2–3 minutes or until most of the liquid has evaporated.

2 Add the peas, coconut milk, stock, sugar, and a good grinding of black pepper and bring to a boil. Reduce the heat to a simmer and cook gently for 30 minutes, stirring frequently. Taste for seasoning, then serve each bowlful garnished with fresh cilantro and a lime wedge.



BLACK-EYED PEAS
So called because of the "black eye" where the bean was originally joined to the pod, black-eyed peas have a creamy, pealike flavor. When shopping for them, choose organic peas that have been canned without sugar and salt.